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MY LAST FULL SEASON

With the 100th hundred finally out of the way, I was looking forward to a busy season of Test cricket at home. For once, we were not touring much and in 2012–13 we were due to host New Zealand, England and Australia. You don't often get to play ten uninterrupted Test matches at home. I had prepared well but must concede things rarely went to plan from a personal point of view. In the lead-up to the season I continued to be bothered by the toe injury, so much so that I visited BKS Iyengar, one of the foremost yoga gurus in the world, together with Zaheer Khan for a day in May 2012, during the fifth edition of the IPL. I had been introduced to Guruji in 1999 by Kiran More when I was suffering from the back injury and had spent a week with him in Pune at the time. In June 2012 I travelled to Germany to the Adidas factory to get some special shoes made and during this visit I was accompanied by Prof. Cathy Speed, who had travelled from London to be with me.

In August 2012, we won both Tests against New Zealand, with Ravichandran Ashwin and Pragyan Ojha bowling well and getting us wickets at regular intervals. In each of my three innings in the series, I got a start before being bowled, which prompted a lot of speculation in the press about my technique – had my reflexes slowed down and was I the batsman I once was? In my mind, however, there was nothing seriously wrong with my technique or my approach. One problem, perhaps, was that in the off season I had trained a lot indoors and had got too used to the high indoor bounce. In Hyderabad in the first Test, for example, I was dismissed for 19 by a delivery from Trent Boult that I expected to bounce more.